Niraj Patel

SF Bay Area, USA nirajumeshbhaipatel@gmail.com +1 (857) 339-8633 linkedin.com/in/niraj-patel-a11516154

SUMMARY

DevOps / Platform Engineer with 5+ years of experience securing and scaling cloud-native platforms for regulated healthcare. Builds multi-account AWS and EKS foundations with Terraform, ships through GitOps pipelines, and keeps services reliable with SLOs, OpenTelemetry and disciplined incident response, sustaining 99.95% availability. Turns HIPAA, HITRUST and SOC 2 requirements into automated guardrails for PHI workloads, from Zero Trust networking to audit-ready evidence, while cutting deployment times by up to 50% and recovery times from hours to minutes.

SKILLS

Languages & OS: Python (FastAPI), Bash, Java, YAML, Linux (RHEL/Ubuntu)
Cloud: AWS (EKS, EC2, VPC, IAM, RDS, S3, KMS, Secrets Manager, Route 53, CloudWatch, Security Hub, AWS Backup, PrivateLink, Transfer Family, Organizations, Transit Gateway), Microsoft Azure, Oracle Cloud (OCI), Multi-Account Landing Zone, Disaster Recovery (RTO/RPO), FinOps
Containers & Orchestration: Kubernetes (EKS, kind), Docker, Helm, Kustomize, Karpenter, HPA/Cluster Autoscaler, Istio, Secrets Store CSI Driver
Infrastructure as Code: Terraform (Modules, Terraform Cloud), Ansible, Policy as Code (OPA, Conftest), Drift Detection
CI/CD & GitOps: ArgoCD, Jenkins, GitHub Actions, Harness, Azure DevOps, GitLab CI, SonarQube, Canary/Blue-Green Deployments
Observability & SRE: Datadog, Prometheus, Grafana, OpenTelemetry, ELK Stack, Splunk, Fluent Bit, CloudWatch, PagerDuty, ServiceNow, SLIs/SLOs, Error Budgets, Distributed Tracing, Incident Response, RCA, Change Management, Capacity Planning, 24x7 On-Call
Security & Compliance: HIPAA, SOC 2, HITRUST, PHI Protection, Compliance-as-Code, Zero Trust, DevSecOps, HashiCorp Vault, Aqua Security, Trivy, Snyk, Checkov, Falco (eBPF), Microsoft Presidio, Kyverno, SBOM, SAST/DAST, mTLS, IAM/RBAC Least Privilege, Encryption at Rest/In Transit
Healthcare Data Exchange: HL7, FHIR, EDI (834/837), SFTP, Synthea (synthetic data)
AI & Automation: LLM API Integration, AIOps, AI-Assisted Incident Triage

EXPERIENCE

DevOps / Platform Engineer

Cigna Healthcare **February 2025 - Present, USA**

- Re-architect CI/CD for 25+ microservices supporting claims, eligibility and pharmacy benefit platforms using Jenkins, GitHub Actions, ArgoCD, SonarQube and Aqua/Trivy, cutting deployment time from 20 to 12 minutes and blocking 120+ critical CVEs before production.
- Develop reusable Terraform and Ansible modules for multi-account AWS with Policy as Code (OPA) and Zero Trust network segmentation (private subnets, VPC endpoints, security groups), supporting 15+ environment builds and reducing setup time from 3 days to under 6 hours.
- Migrated 10+ legacy services to Kubernetes (EKS) using Docker, Helm and Karpenter with Spot instances, achieving zero-downtime cutovers and saving ~$8K/month through right-sizing.
- Implement HIPAA, SOC 2 and HITRUST controls for PHI workloads using HashiCorp Vault, KMS encryption at rest and in transit, IAM least privilege, PHI log masking and AWS Security Hub, supporting an audit with 0 critical findings and reducing evidence-collection time from 2 weeks to 3 days.
- Configure secure partner data exchange for HL7/FHIR APIs and EDI (834/837) files using AWS PrivateLink, AWS Transfer Family (SFTP) and mutual TLS, onboarding 6+ external healthcare partners with zero PHI exposure incidents.

Site Reliability Engineer

Tata Consultancy Services **August 2021 - August 2024, India**

- Participated in on-call and L3 incident response with PagerDuty and Datadog, building auto-triage runbooks, conducting 15+ postmortems and mentoring 3 junior engineers, reducing MTTR from 90 to 35 minutes and Sev-1/Sev-2 incidents from 8 to 3 per quarter.
- Implemented SLIs/SLOs and error budgets for 20+ services using OpenTelemetry, Grafana and CloudWatch, sustaining 99.95% availability on customer-facing APIs.
- Implemented and tested a multi-AZ disaster recovery setup on AWS using Terraform, RDS Multi-AZ, AWS Backup and Route 53 failover, validated through quarterly DR drills, cutting RTO from 4 hours to 45 minutes with a 15-minute RPO.
- Migrated 3 Terraform codebases spanning 25+ components from Azure DevOps to Harness, standardizing pipeline structure across the platform and cutting deployment time from 60 to 30 minutes.
- Automated monthly credential rotation for 50+ Oracle Cloud (OCI) applications using Python and Ansible, eliminating manual handling of workload identities and saving the 5-person platform team ~3 hours per month.
- Hardened cross-cloud access by provisioning a Zero Trust Azure jump server for Oracle Cloud via Terraform and Ansible, removing public exposure of data-platform resources.

PROJECT

PHI Guard: HIPAA Compliance-as-Code and PHI Leak Detection Engine

- Automated 25+ compliance checks mapped to HIPAA Security Rule technical safeguards (45 CFR §164.312) using OPA/Conftest and Checkov across Terraform plans and Kubernetes manifests, generating a per-commit audit evidence report in GitHub Actions in under 3 minutes.
- Built runtime PHI leak detection in a lab Kubernetes cluster by streaming container logs through Microsoft Presidio with custom recognizers (MRN, member ID, NPI) and flagging suspicious egress with Falco eBPF rules, catching 45 of 50 seeded PHI leaks in synthetic Synthea data.
- Added an LLM-based assistant in Python that translated failed controls into plain-English findings with the matching HIPAA citation and a suggested Terraform or YAML fix, cutting manual review time per finding from ~10 minutes to ~2 minutes in lab tests.

EDUCATION

Master of Science in Software Engineering System

Northeastern University · Boston, MA · 2026

Bachelor of Engineering in Electrical Engineering

Gujarat Technological University · India · 2022